TechWiz Product Care & Maintenance Guide

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Proper care and maintenance can significantly extend the life of your electronics and keep them performing at their best. This guide provides category-specific care tips, cleaning instructions, and troubleshooting advice.

General Care Guidelines

Environmental Conditions

Temperature:

- Operating: 10°C to 35°C (50°F to 95°F)
- Storage: -20°C to 45°C (-4°F to 113°F)
- Avoid extreme temperature changes (don't leave in hot cars or freezing garages)

Humidity:

- Keep devices in environments with 20-80% relative humidity
- Avoid condensation (bringing cold device into warm room - let it acclimate)
- Never use devices near water unless rated IP67 or higher

Physical Environment:

- Keep away from direct sunlight for extended periods
- Avoid dusty or dirty environments when possible
- Don't block ventilation holes or air vents
- Use on stable, flat surfaces

Power Management

All Electronics:

- Use only manufacturer-approved chargers and cables
- Unplug devices during thunderstorms
- Don't overload power outlets
- Use surge protectors for expensive equipment

Laptops & Desktop Computers

Daily Care

Physical Handling:

- Always lift laptops by the base, not the screen
- Close lid gently; don't use laptop as a tray
- Keep liquids away from keyboards
- Don't eat over your keyboard

Ventilation:

- Ensure air vents are never blocked
- Don't use laptops on soft surfaces (beds, couches) for extended periods
- Consider a laptop cooling pad for gaming or intensive tasks
- **Clean vents every 3-6 months** with compressed air

Screen Care

Cleaning Process:

1. Turn off and unplug the device
2. Use microfiber cloth slightly dampened with water
3. Wipe gently in circular motions
4. For stubborn marks, use 70% isopropyl alcohol wipe
5. Never spray liquid directly on screen
6. Avoid paper towels (can scratch)

Protection:

- Adjust brightness to comfortable levels (reduces eye strain and power consumption)
- Use screen protector for touch screens
- Close lid when transporting

Keyboard & Trackpad

Cleaning:

- Turn off device
- Hold upside down and gently shake to dislodge debris
- Use compressed air in short bursts between keys
- Wipe keys with slightly damp microfiber cloth
- For deep cleaning: use cotton swabs with 70% isopropyl alcohol
- **Clean every 2-4 weeks** if used daily

Trackpad:

- Wipe with microfiber cloth daily
- Avoid using with greasy or wet hands
- Disable trackpad when using external mouse to prevent accidental inputs

Storage

Short-term (days to weeks):

- Shut down fully or use sleep mode
- Ensure battery isn't fully depleted

Long-term (months):

- Charge battery to 50-60% before storage

- Power on every 3 months and charge to 60%
- Store in cool, dry place
- Remove external devices

Smartphones & Tablets

Screen Protection

Essential Protection:

- Use tempered glass screen protector (replace every 6-12 months)
- Use protective case (reduces impact damage by up to 70%)
- Consider camera lens protector for high-end phones

Daily Care:

- Clean screen daily with microfiber cloth
- Avoid keeping in pockets with keys or coins
- Don't use phone with wet hands if not water-resistant
- Remove case and clean every 2 weeks (dirt accumulates)

Port Maintenance

Charging Ports:

- Inspect monthly for lint, dust, or debris
- Clean gently with wooden toothpick or compressed air
- **Never use metal objects** (can damage pins)
- If port feels loose, visit service center

Headphone Jacks (if applicable):

- Clean monthly with compressed air
- Don't force connectors in
- Remove headphones gently (don't yank)

Water Exposure

If Water-Resistant (IP67/IP68):

- Rinse with fresh water if exposed to salt water, chlorine, or soap
- Dry charging port thoroughly before plugging in
- Water resistance decreases over time (seals degrade)

If NOT Water-Resistant:

- Immediately power off if water contact occurs
- Do NOT charge or turn on
- Dry exterior gently
- Contact TechWiz support or service center within 24 hours

Audio Equipment (Headphones, Speakers, Earbuds)

Headphones & Earbuds

Hygiene:

- Clean earbuds weekly with 70% isopropyl alcohol wipe
- Remove and wash silicone/foam tips weekly
- Replace ear tips every 3-6 months
- Never share earbuds without cleaning first

Storage:

- Use provided case when not in use
- Don't wrap cable tightly around device
- Store in dry environment
- Keep away from extreme temperatures

Cable Care:

- Don't yank cable to remove from device
- Avoid tight bends or kinks
- Wrap loosely when storing
- If cable becomes stiff or cracked, replace immediately (safety hazard)

Speakers

Cleaning:

- Use soft brush to remove dust from grills weekly
- Wipe exterior with slightly damp cloth
- **Never spray liquid** onto speakers
- For fabric-covered speakers, use lint roller

Placement:

- Keep away from windows (sun exposure damages components)
- Don't place directly on floor (vibrations and dust)
- Ensure adequate clearance from walls for bass ports
- Avoid humid environments (bathrooms, near humidifiers)

TVs & Monitors

Screen Cleaning

Best Practices:

- Power off and let cool for 10 minutes
- Use microfiber cloth designed for screens
- For tougher marks, slightly dampen with distilled water
- Wipe in gentle, circular motions

- **Clean every 2-4 weeks**, or when visibly dusty

What to NEVER Use:

- Window cleaner (Windex, etc.) - contains ammonia
- Paper towels - too abrasive
- Furniture polish - leaves residue
- Rough cloths - can scratch

Placement & Setup

Positioning:

- Mount securely using appropriate VESA mount
- If on stand, ensure surface is stable and level
- Keep away from heat sources (radiators, fireplaces)
- Avoid direct sunlight on screen

Ventilation:

- Ensure 10cm (4 inches) clearance on all sides
- Don't enclose in cabinets without ventilation
- Clean dust from vents every 3 months

Burn-In Prevention (OLED TVs)

- Enable screen saver for static content
- Vary content type (don't leave on news channels 24/7)
- Use pixel refresher feature quarterly (in TV settings)
- Reduce brightness and contrast slightly
- Enable automatic brightness limiter

Battery-Powered Devices

Maximizing Battery Lifespan

Best Charging Practices:

- Keep charge between 20% and 80% for longest life
- Avoid letting battery fully drain frequently
- Don't leave plugged in at 100% constantly
- Charge in cool environment (not in hot car or direct sun)
- Use original or certified chargers only

Calibration (Every 3 months):

1. Charge to 100%
2. Use device until it powers off (0%)
3. Leave off for 3 hours
4. Charge to 100% without interruption
5. Resume normal charging habits

Temperature Impact:

- Batteries degrade faster in heat
- Below 0°C: charging slows or stops
- Above 35°C: permanent capacity loss accelerates
- **Ideal**: charge and store at 15-25°C

Long-Term Storage

If not using a device for over 1 month:

- Charge to 50-60%
- Power off completely
- Store in cool, dry place
- Check every 3 months; recharge to 50% if below 30%

Software Maintenance

Operating System Updates

Importance:

- Security patches protect against vulnerabilities
- Performance improvements
- New features
- Bug fixes

Best Practices:

- Enable automatic updates where possible
- For manual updates, check monthly
- Backup data before major updates
- Update during off-hours (updates can take 30-60 minutes)

Windows: Settings → Windows Update **macOS**: System Settings → General → Software Update **Android**: Settings → System → System Update **iOS**: Settings → General → Software Update

Driver Updates

- Update graphics drivers quarterly (especially for gaming)
- Update printer, scanner drivers as needed
- Manufacturer websites have latest drivers
- Use Windows Update or Mac Software Update for most drivers

Storage Management

Prevent Slowdowns:

- Keep at least 15-20% storage free
- Delete unnecessary files monthly
- Empty trash/recycle bin regularly

- Uninstall unused applications

Tools:

- Windows: Storage Sense (Settings → System → Storage)
- macOS: Optimize Storage (About This Mac → Storage)
- Third-party: CCleaner, TreeSize (use cautiously)

Common Troubleshooting Tips

Device Won't Turn On

1. Check power source (plug into different outlet)
2. For battery devices, charge for 30 minutes
3. Try hard reset (hold power button 10-15 seconds)
4. Check for physical damage to power port
5. If still not working, contact TechWiz support

Device Overheating

Immediate Actions:

- Power off and let cool for 20 minutes
- Remove from case if applicable
- Move to cooler environment
- Close unnecessary applications

Prevention:

- Clean vents and fans regularly
- Don't use on soft surfaces
- Reduce brightness
- Close background apps
- Consider cooling pad for laptops

Slow Performance

Quick Fixes:

1. Restart device (clears RAM)
2. Close unnecessary programs/tabs
3. Check for software updates
4. Run antivirus scan
5. Free up storage space
6. Disable startup programs (Windows/Mac)

When to Seek Help:

- Slowness persists after troubleshooting
- Random crashes or freezes
- Strange noises from device

- Excessive heat

Wi-Fi Connection Issues

1. Restart router and device
2. Forget network and reconnect
3. Check if other devices can connect
4. Move closer to router
5. Update device Wi-Fi drivers
6. Reset network settings (Settings → Network → Reset)

When to Seek Professional Service

Contact TechWiz support or authorized service center if:

- Physical damage (cracked screen, bent chassis)
- Liquid damage
- Battery swelling or deformation
- Burning smell or excessive heat
- Repeated system crashes
- Hardware error messages
- Unusual noises (clicking, grinding)

Never Attempt:

- Opening sealed devices (voids warranty)
- Replacing components yourself unless experienced
- Using unauthorized repair services (voids warranty)

Recommended Maintenance Schedule

Task	Frequency
Screen cleaning	Weekly
Case/body cleaning	Weekly
Keyboard cleaning	Bi-weekly
Vent inspection	Monthly
Software updates	Monthly
Deep vent cleaning	Quarterly
Battery calibration	Quarterly
Full system backup	Monthly

Professional Cleaning Services

TechWiz offers professional cleaning and maintenance:

- Deep internal cleaning: £49.99
- Thermal paste replacement (laptops): £29.99
- Dust removal and vent cleaning: £24.99

Gold Loyalty Members: One free annual cleaning service.

Book: Visit techwiz.co.uk/service or call 0800 123 4567

Additional Resources

- Video tutorials: techwiz.co.uk/video-guides
- Downloadable checklists: techwiz.co.uk/maintenance-checklists
- Product-specific guides: Available on individual product pages

Contact Us

Product Care Questions:

- Email: support@techwiz.co.uk
- Phone: 0800 123 4567
- Live Chat: Available on website Mon-Fri 9am-8pm GMT

Proper care today means better performance tomorrow. A little maintenance goes a long way!